

RESOURCE 09 · INTERVIEW

The Why This Role Framework

Three separate questions, each with its own research. Answer them one at a time and you stop sounding like every other candidate.

WHY THIS COMPANY

Research the company

What's actually happening here, not what the careers page says.

WHERE TO LOOK

- › Last 2 earnings calls or funding announcements
- › The CEO's recent posts and podcast interviews
- › Their engineering or product blog
- › Glassdoor and Blind, but only for the patterns

LANDS WHEN...

"You just shifted from X to Y, and that's the kind of bet I want to be part of building."

WHY THIS ROLE

Research the role

The actual work, the team, the surface area you'd own.

WHERE TO LOOK

- › The JD, read twice; the top 3 things they need
- › The hiring manager's LinkedIn and recent posts
- › The team's repos, talks, or shipped features
- › The recruiter screen, mined for hints on priorities

LANDS WHEN...

"Owning the migration off the legacy pipeline is exactly the kind of work I want my next step to be."

WHY NOW

Research yourself

Your timing and career arc. Why this, why now, why not next year.

WHERE TO LOOK

- › What you've outgrown in your current role
- › The skill or scope you're reaching for next
- › What changed recently (team, scope, market)
- › Why this opportunity beats staying put

LANDS WHEN...

"I've spent three years going deep on infra; I'm ready to apply it to a product surface with real users."

COMMON FUMBLES

- ✗ "I'm just looking for a great opportunity."
- ✗ "I've heard good things about the team."

- ✗ "I want to grow."
- ✗ "It's a great company."

- ✗ "I'm passionate about [your domain]."
- ✗ "I just want my next role."